

Kelly’s Dairy v2.0

A beautiful, single-file note-taking app with a stunning gradient background, prominent taskbar with save button, and rock-solid save functionality.

What’s New in v2.0

Feature	v1.0	v2.0
Save Button	Hidden in editor	Prominent taskbar button
Background	Plain white	Beautiful gradient + milk drops
Taskbar	None	Full top taskbar with status
Save Reliability	Basic	Rock-solid with validation
UI Polish	Simple	Cards, shadows, warm palette

Quick Start

Requirements

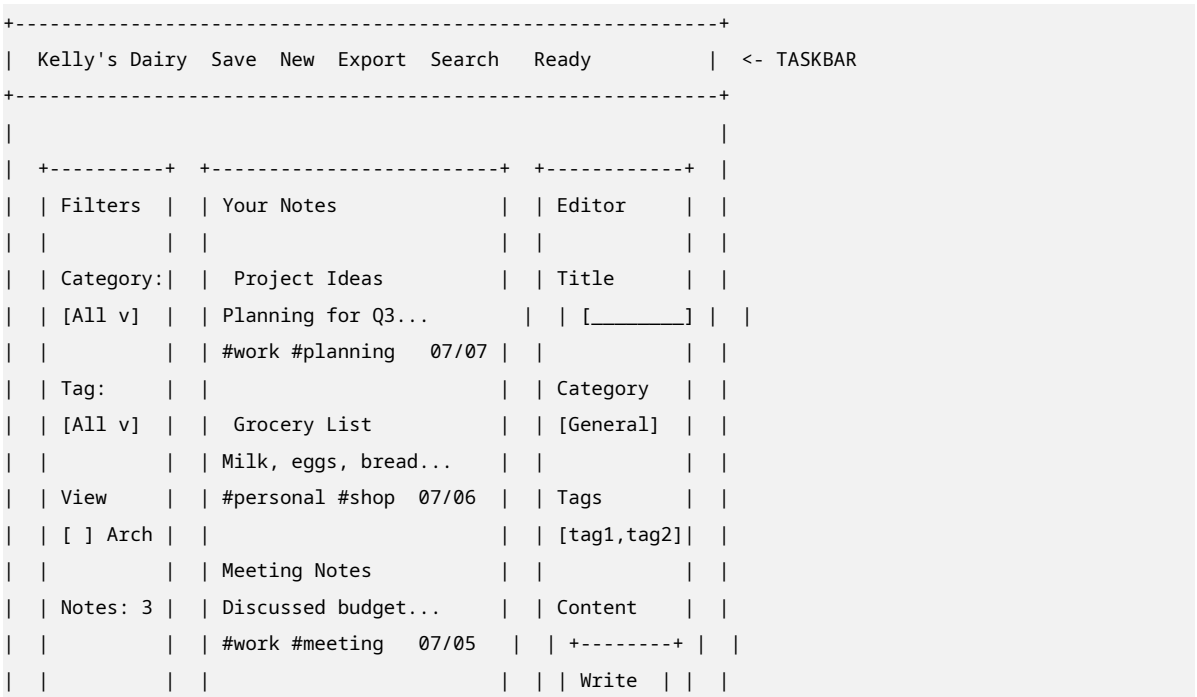
- Python 3.8+
- Tkinter (usually included with Python)

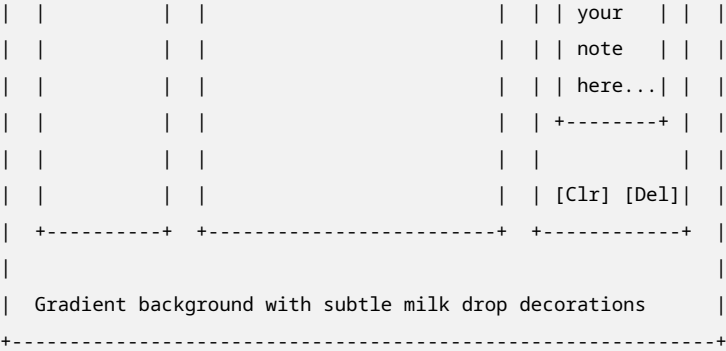
Run

```
python kellys_dairy.py
```

No pip install needed!

Beautiful UI Overview





How to Save (The Right Way)

Method 1: Taskbar Save Button (Recommended)

1. Write your note in the **Editor** (right panel)
2. Click **Save Note** in the **top taskbar**
3. See “Updated: Your Note Title” in the status bar

Method 2: Keyboard Shortcut

- Press Ctrl + S anytime to save

Method 3: Auto-Save

- The app auto-saves every **5 minutes**
- Status bar shows “Auto-saved”

Creating Your First Note

1. Click **New** in the taskbar (or press **Ctrl + N**)
2. Enter a **Title** in the editor
3. Choose a **Category** (e.g., “Work”, “Personal”)
4. Add **Tags** (comma-separated, e.g., “urgent, meeting”)
5. Write your **Content**
6. Click **Save Note** in the taskbar
7. Your note appears in the center panel!

Theme & Colors

Kelly's Dairy uses a warm, dairy-inspired palette:

Element	Color	Hex
Background (top)	Cream White	#FFF8F0
Background (bottom)	Warm Beige	#F5E6D3
Cards	Soft White	#FFFDF8
Taskbar	Dark Chocolate	#3D2914
Accent	Caramel	#D4A574
Success	Fresh Green	#7CB342
Danger	Soft Red	#E57373

Table 2 – continued

Element	Color	Hex
Info	Sky Blue	#64B5F6
Pinned Notes	Butter Yellow	#FFF3E0

Troubleshooting

“My notes aren’t saving!”

Check 1: Are you clicking the **Save Note** button in the **taskbar** (top), not just typing?

Check 2: Look at the **status bar** (right side of taskbar). It should say:

- “Updated: Your Note Title” - saved successfully
- “Update failed” - something went wrong

Check 3: Check if `kellys_dairy_notes.json` was created in the same folder.

Check 4: Make sure you have **write permissions** in the folder. Try moving the script to your Documents folder.

Error: Permission denied

Fix: Move the script to a folder where you have write permissions:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Documents
python kellys_dairy.py
```

Error: No module named ‘tkinter’

Windows: Reinstall Python and check “tcl/tk and IDLE” in the installer.

Linux:

```
sudo apt-get install python3-tk
```

Mac:

```
brew install python-tk@3.12
```

Notes disappeared!

Don’t panic! Check the `kellys_dairy_backups/` folder. The app keeps the last 10 backups automatically.

To restore:

1. Close the app
2. Copy a backup file to `kellys_dairy_notes.json`
3. Restart the app

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + N	New Note
Ctrl + S	Save Note
Ctrl + F	Focus Search

Data Files

When you run the app, it creates these in the same folder:

```
kellys_dairy_notes.json      <- Your notes (auto-created)
kellys_dairy_backups/       <- Auto-backups (auto-created)
  |-- notes_backup_20260707_120000.json
  |-- notes_backup_20260707_130000.json
  |-- ...
```

Architecture

```
Kelly's Dairy v2.0
|-- GradientCanvas          <- Beautiful background
|-- NoteManager             <- Data layer (CRUD, persistence)
|-- NoteCard                <- Clickable note widgets
|-- KellysDairyApp
  |-- _build_taskbar()      <- Top taskbar with save
  |-- _build_sidebar()      <- Filters panel
  |-- _build_notes_list()   <- Scrollable note cards
  |-- _build_editor()       <- Note editor
```

Customization

Change Colors

Edit the colors dictionary in `KellysDairyApp.__init__`:

```
self.colors = {
    "bg_top": "#YOUR_COLOR",      # Top gradient
    "bg_bottom": "#YOUR_COLOR",  # Bottom gradient
    "taskbar": "#YOUR_COLOR",     # Taskbar
    # ...
}
```

Change Auto-Save Interval

Edit the `_autosave` method (line ~700):

```
self.root.after(300000, self._autosave) # 300000ms = 5 minutes
# Change to 60000 for 1 minute, 600000 for 10 minutes
```

License

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